

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

Index No.:

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CLARICE PANTOJA

SUMMONS

Plaintiff,

-against-

Plaintiff resides at:
225 Willis Avenue, Apt. 4H
Bronx, New York 10454

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE
DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER KARANVEE BALAGAD
SHIELD # 15738 OF THE 25TH PRECINCT,

Defendants,

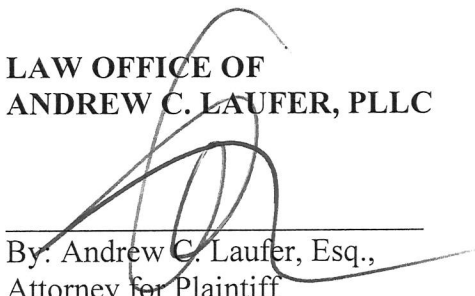
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To the above named Defendants:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the Complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your Answer, or, if the Complaint is not served with this Summons, to serve a notice of appearance on the Plaintiff's attorney within 20 days after service of this Summons or within 30 days after the service is complete if this Summons is not personally delivered to you within the state of New York; and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

The basis of the venue designated is the place of incident.

Dated: New York, New York
November 21, 2017

**LAW OFFICE OF
ANDREW C. LAUFER, PLLC**


By: Andrew C. Laufer, Esq.,
Attorney for Plaintiff
255 W 36th Street, Suite 1104
New York, New York 10018
(212)422-1020

DEFENDANT'S ADDRESS

THE CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street, 4th Floor
New York, New York 10007

NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT
c/o CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street, 4th Floor
New York, New York 10007

POLICE OFFICER KARANVEE BALAGAD
SHIELD # 15738 OF THE 25TH PRECINCT
120 E 119th Street
New York, NY 10035

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

Index No.:

-----X
CLARICE PANTOJA,

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

Plaintiffs,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE
DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER KARANVEE BALAGAD
SHIELD # 15738 OF THE 25TH PRECINCT,

Defendants,

-----X

Plaintiff, by and through her attorney, Law Office of Andrew C. Laufer, PLLC
complaining of the Defendants herein, upon information and belief, respectfully show to this
Court, and allege as follows:

PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, the Plaintiff was a resident of the County of Bronx, City and State of New York.
2. That at all times hereinafter mentioned Defendant, THE CITY OF NEW YORK was and is a municipal corporation, duly organized and existing under by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.
3. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT was and is a municipal corporation, duly organized and existing under by virtue of the laws of the State of New York.
4. That at all times hereinafter mentioned Defendants, POLICE OFFICER KARANVEE BALAGAD, SHIELD # 15738 OF THE 25TH PRECINCT, was and still is employed with the NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT.
5. That prior to the institution of this action, a Notice of Claim was duly served upon and filed with the CITY OF NEW YORK on behalf of Plaintiff.

6. That a hearing was held on October 13, 2017 by the CITY OF NEW YORK pursuant to Municipal Law 50-h.

7. That at all time herein mentioned, POLICE OFFICER KARANVEE BALAGAD, SHIELD # 15738 OF THE 25TH PRECINCT, was acting within the scope and course of her employment with the New York Police Department, and under color of State Law.

8. That at all times herein mentioned, POLICE OFFICER KARANVEE BALAGAD, SHIELD # 15738 OF THE 25TH PRECINCT was acting in their individual and official capacity as employees of Defendants THE CITY OF NEW YORK (CITY) and NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT (NYPD).

9. That all the causes of action pleaded herein fall within one or more of the exceptions set forth in New York's Civil Practice Law & Rules 1602 with respect to joint and several liability.

STATEMENT OF FACTS AS TO ALL CAUSES OF ACTION

10. On or about March 11, 2017, at approximately 3:00 a.m., Plaintiff CLARICE PANTOJA was lawfully at the 116th Street and First Avenue, in the County, City, and State of New York.

11. At said place, the plaintiff was unlawfully detained and arrested by the defendants for a crime she did not commit.

12. She was then taken to the 25th precinct where she was held and processed until such time that she was taken to central booking at approximately 11:00 a.m.

13. She was then presented before the Court at 5:30 p.m. whereby she pled not guilty and was released on her own recognizance.

14. On or about April 27, 2017, all charges were dismissed and sealed.

15. The individual Defendants, POLICE OFFICER KARANVEE BALAGAD, SHIELD # 15738 OF THE 25TH PRECINCT, under color of state law, subjected Plaintiff to the foregoing

acts and omissions without due process of the law, thereby depriving Plaintiff of his rights, privileges and immunities secured by the First, Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, including without limitation, deprivation of the following constitutional rights: (a) freedom from unreasonable searches and seizure of his person, including the excessive use of force; (b) freedom from arrest without probable cause; (c) freedom from false imprisonment, meaning wrongful detention without good faith, reasonable suspicion or legal justification of which Plaintiff was aware and did not consent; (d) freedom from the lodging of false charges against her by police; (e) freedom from abuse of process; and (f) the enjoyment of equal protection, privileges and immunities under the laws.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION FOR VIOLATION OF PLAINTIFF'S RIGHT UNDER THE
FOURTH, FIFTH AND FOURTEENTH AMENDMENTS TO THE UNITED STATES
CONSTITUTION AND NEW YORK STATE LAW PREDICATED UPON FALSE ARREST
AND IMPRISONMENT

16. Plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation contained above as though set forth at length herein.

17. That on or about March 11, 2017, at approximately 3:00 a.m., THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT, its agents, servants and employees, including but not limited to POLICE OFFICER KARANVEE BALAGAD, SHIELD # 15738 OF THE 25TH PRECINCT, wrongfully and falsely arrested, imprisoned and detained Plaintiff without any right or justifiable grounds therefore.

18. That on or about March 11, 2017, at approximately 3:00 a.m., Defendant POLICE OFFICER KARANVEE BALAGAD, SHIELD # 15738 OF THE 25TH PRECINCT, jointly and severally in their capacity as police officers, wrongfully stopped, handcuffed, and seized the Plaintiff about his person, causing him physical pain and mental suffering. At no time did Defendants have legal cause to stop, handcuff, seize or touch Plaintiff, nor did Plaintiff consent to this illegal touching nor was or privileged by law.

19. That on or about March 11, 2017, at approximately 3:00 a.m., Defendants, jointly and severally without any warrant, order or other legal process and without legal right, wrongfully and unlawfully arrested Plaintiff, restrained her and her liberty and then took her into custody to the 25th Precinct.

20. Plaintiff was thereafter held at the 25th Precinct, for a several hours until she was transported to central booking where she was held for several more hours.

21. That the aforesaid arrest, detention and imprisonment continued at the 25th Precinct in New York, New York and elsewhere.

22. That the said arrest, detention and imprisonment was caused by the CITY, its agents, servants and employees, including but not limited to the Defendant police officer, without a warrant and without any reasonable cause or belief that Plaintiff was in fact guilty of any crime.

23. That the CITY, its agents, servants and employees, as set forth above, intended to confine Plaintiff; that Plaintiff was conscious of the confinement; that Plaintiff did not consent to the confinement; and that the confinement was not otherwise privileged.

24. As a result of the aforesaid actions, including the arrest and imprisonment of Plaintiff without probable cause, Defendants deprived Plaintiff of the rights, privileges and immunities secured by the Constitution and Laws of the United States of America and the Fourteenth Amendment.

25. As a result of the aforementioned actions, Defendants deprived Plaintiff of the right to be free from unreasonable search and seizures secured by the Constitution and Laws of the United States of America and the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments.

26. As a result of the aforementioned actions, Defendants deprived Plaintiff of her right to liberty without due process of law secured by the Constitution and Laws of the United States of America and the Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments.

27. The aforementioned acts of Defendants were intentional, willful and malicious and performed with a reckless disregard for and deliberate indifference to Plaintiff's rights.

28. That by reason of the false arrest, imprisonment and detention of Plaintiff, Plaintiff was subjected to great indignities, humiliation and ridicule in being so detained, and was greatly injured in her credit and circumstances and was prevented and hindered from performing and transacting her necessary affairs and was caused to suffer much pain in both mind and body, and to sustain economic loss, and was otherwise damaged.

29. The aforescribed constitutional violations are all actionable under and pursuant to 42 U.S.C. §§ 1981, 1983, 1985, 1986 and under the laws of New York State.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION FOR VIOLATION OF PLAINTIFF'S RIGHTS UNDER THE
FOURTH, FIFTH AND FOURTEENTH AMENDMENTS TO THE UNITED STATES
CONSTITUTION AND NEW YORK STATE LAW PREDICATED UPON THE MALICIOUS
PROSECUTION OF PLAINTIFF

30. Plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation contained herein as if fully set forth at length herein.

31. Upon information and belief, on or about March 11, 2017, at approximately 3:00 a.m. and from that time until the dismissal of charges, which was favorable termination for the accused, Defendants deliberately and maliciously prosecuted Plaintiff, an innocent woman without any probable cause whatsoever, by filing or causing a criminal complaint to be filed in the Criminal Court of the City of New York, New York County, for the purpose of falsely accusing the Plaintiff of violations of the criminal laws of the State of New York.

32. The commencement of these criminal proceedings was malicious and began with malice and without probable cause, so that the proceedings could succeed by the Defendants.

33. As a result of the aforementioned actions, including the initiation of the criminal prosecution of Plaintiff without probable cause, Defendants deprived Plaintiff of the rights, privileges and immunities secured by the Constitution and Laws of the United States of America and the Fourteenth Amendment.

34. As a result of the aforementioned actions, Defendants deprived Plaintiff of the right to be free from unreasonable search and seizures secured by the Constitution and laws of the United States and the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments.

35. As a result of the aforementioned actions, Defendants deprived Plaintiff of the right to liberty without due process of law secured by the Constitution and Laws of the United States of America and the Fifth and Fourteenth Amendments.

36. The aforementioned conduct by Defendants was motivated and instigated by other than lawful reasons and without probable cause.

37. The aforementioned acts of Defendants were intentional, willful and malicious and performed with reckless disregard for and deliberate indifference to Plaintiff's rights.

38. Plaintiff has suffered humiliation, mental anguish, indignity and frustration of an unjust criminal prosecution.

39. The aforementioned constitutional violations are all actionable under and pursuant to 42 U.S.C. §§ 1981, 1983, 1985, 1986 and under New York State Law.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION AGAINST DEFENDANT CITY
MONELL CLAIM PURSUANT TO 42 U.S.C § 1983 AND RESPONDEAT SUPERIOR

40. Plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation contained herein as if fully set forth at length herein.

41. All of the acts and omissions by the individual Defendants, described above were carried out pursuant to overlapping policies and practices of the CITY which were in existence at the time of the conduct alleged herein and were engaged in with the full knowledge, consent and cooperation and under the supervisory authority of Defendants CITY and the NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT (NYPD).

42. Defendants CITY and NYPD, by their policy-making agents, servants and employees, authorized sanctioned and/or ratified the individual Defendants' wrongful acts, and/or failed to properly discipline said officers in their employee, and/or failed to prevent or stop those acts and/or allowed those acts to continue.

43. Defendants arrested, incarcerated and prosecuted Plaintiff in the absence of any evidence of criminal wrongdoing, notwithstanding their knowledge that said arrest and incarceration would jeopardize Plaintiff's liberty, well-being, safety and constitutional rights.

44. At all times mentioned herein, said police officer was acting under color of law, to wit: the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies and customs and usage of the State of New York and/or City of New York.

45. On or about March 11, 2017, at approximately 3:00 a.m., Defendants did stop, seize, search, and grab the persons of the Plaintiff without a court authorized arrest or search warrant. They did physically seize the person of the Plaintiff during the arrest process in an unlawful and excessive manner.

46. The Plaintiff was falsely arrested, unlawfully imprisoned and maliciously prosecuted without the Defendants' possessing probable cause to do so.

47. The above actions of Defendants resulted in the Plaintiff being deprived of the following rights under the United States Constitution.

- a. Freedom from illegal search and seizure.
- b. Freedom from false arrest.
- c. Freedom from malicious prosecution.
- d. Freedom from unlawful imprisonment.

48. The Defendants subjected Plaintiff to such deprivations, either in a malicious or reckless disregard of the Plaintiff's rights.

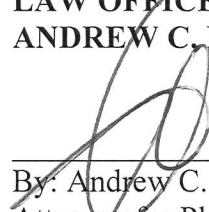
49. Defendant CITY has grossly failed to train and adequately supervise its police officers in the fundamental law of arrest, search and seizure especially when it's police officers are not in possession of a court authorized arrest warrant and where an individual, especially as here, has not committed a crime and has not resisted arrest, that its police officers should only use reasonable force to effectuate an arrest and the arrest should be based upon probable cause.

50. The direct and proximate results of the Defendants' acts are that Plaintiff suffered severe and permanent injuries of a psychological nature. She was forced to endure pain and suffering to her detriment.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff demands judgment against Defendants, and each of them, on all of the foregoing causes of action, in the form of compensatory damages for her pain and suffering, loss of enjoyment of life, and economic loss, in an amount that exceeds the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts that otherwise would have jurisdiction in the matter, and Plaintiff further demands punitive damages on all causes of action, in an amount to be determined by the trier of fact, together with attorney's fees, and together with costs and disbursements.

Dated: New York, New York
November 21, 2017

**LAW OFFICE OF
ANDREW C. LAUFER, PLLC**



By: Andrew C. Laufer, Esq.,
Attorney for Plaintiff
255 W 36th Street, Suite 1104
New York, New York 10018
(212)422-1020

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

Index No.:

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CLARICE PANTOJA,

Plaintiffs,

VERIFICATION

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE
DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER KARANVEE BALAGAD
SHIELD # 15738 OF THE 25TH PRECINCT,

Defendants,

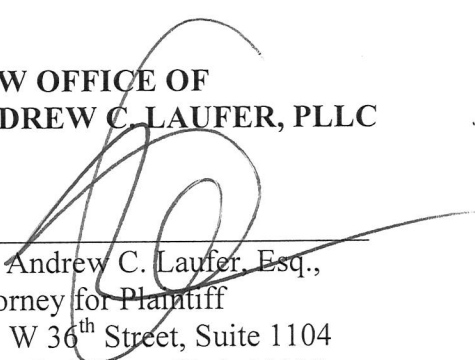
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ANDREW C. LAUFER, an attorney duly admitted to practice law in the Courts of New York, affirms the following to be true:

1. That I am a principal of the Law Office of Andrew C. Laufer, PLLC, attorney for the plaintiff in the within action. That I have read the foregoing complaint and know the contents thereof, and that the same are true to my knowledge, except as to the matters herein stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and that as to these matters I believe them to be true.
2. That the sources of my information and knowledge are records and investigation reports maintained within the file.
3. That the reason this verification is made by the affirmant and not by the plaintiff is that the plaintiff does not reside in the County of New York, which is the county wherein this firm maintains its office.

Dated: New York, New York
November 21, 2017

**LAW OFFICE OF
ANDREW C. LAUFER, PLLC**


By: Andrew C. Laufer, Esq.,
Attorney for Plaintiff
255 W 36th Street, Suite 1104
New York, New York 10018
(212)422-1020

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
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CLARICE PANTOJA,

Plaintiff,

-against-

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, NEW YORK CITY POLICE
DEPARTMENT, POLICE OFFICER KARANVEE BALAGAD
SHIELD #15738 OF THE 25th PRECINCT,

Defendants,

SUMMONS AND COMPLAINT

LAW OFFICE OF ANDREW C. LAUFER

Attorney(s) for Plaintiff

Office and Post Office Address
255 W. 36th Street, Suite 1104
New York, NY 10018

Tel: (212) 422 1020

Fax: (212) 422 1069

To:

Signature (Rule 130-1.1-a)

Print name beneath

Service of a copy of the within is hereby admitted.

Dated: _____

Attorney(s) for:

PLEASE TAKE NOTICE:☐ **NOTICE OF ENTRY**

that the within is a (certified) true copy of a
duly entered in the office of the clerk of the within named court on

☐ **NOTICE OF SETTLEMENT**

that an order of which the within is a true copy
will be presented for settlement to the HON one of the judges of the
within named Court at

on _____ at _____ M.

Dated,

Yours, etc.

Law Office of Andrew C. Laufer